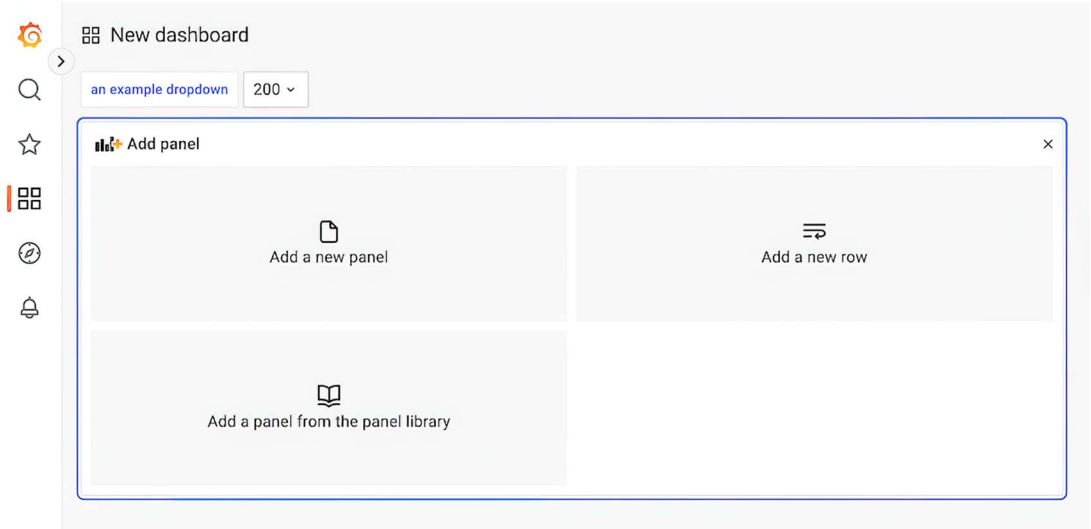


Figure 6.3 Our example dashboard variable `test` rendered in the dashboard

API, including UI support to use variables and transformations in a correlation (http://mng.bz/AoPz).

Now that you have defined the variable `test`, you can use it, for example, in a dashboard query to parameterize it. Let's do exactly that. First, we need a panel that holds the visualization, so create one by clicking the Add a New Panel button. Since we defined Prometheus as the default data source, Grafana picks a suitable visualization (of type time series) for us.

There is also already a placeholder (empty) query there called `A`. For the following, make sure you're in the Code (and not the default Builder) mode; this is something you can toggle on the upper-right-hand side of the query. Now, enter the following parameterized PromQL query in the Metrics Browser input field:

```
rate(
  prometheus_http_requests_total{code="$test"}[5m]
)
```

This query uses our previously defined Grafana dashboard variable `test` to filter the label values. Put in other words, let the dashboard user select which HTTP status code to query for (with HTTP status code `200` as the default). Figure 6.4 shows the result of the parameterized query in the dashboard editor (press the Apply button in the upper-right-hand corner when you're happy with it and want to try the dashboard).

Figure 6.5 shows the result of the dashboard variable `test` used in our PromQL query, allowing you to select the HTTP status code. If you select a different value, like `301`, it's likely that the panel is empty, which is expected, since no such label values